Leaders

"TAPE-OUT Is Not The Finish Line—It's Where The Real VALIDATION BEGINS."

Sudeep Shivalli of Synopsys India tells EFY's Nidhi Agarwal why great chip design is only the first step in building a successful product.



SUDEEP SHIVALLI
REGIONAL SENIOR DIRECTOR – GTM, SYNOPSYS INDIA

On opportunity and execution

EFY: Where are the biggest opportunities for Indian chip designers today?

Sudeep Shivalli: India has a strong semiconductor design ecosystem, with many global chip companies running large engineering and design centres in the country. These teams are already working on advanced chip designs across areas such as data centres, artificial intelligence (AI), edge AI, and automotive electronics, creating significant opportunities for engineers and design teams.

From an industry perspective, three major trends are shaping the market: AI, software-defined systems, and silicon proliferation. The last is particularly relevant to India. As more sectors adopt specialised semiconductor solutions, demand is growing for chips tailored to railways, cameras, ships, industrial equipment, and other locally developed systems. Government initiatives encouraging domestic design and development in these sectors are also opening up new opportunities for Indian semiconductor teams to contribute to products designed and built in India.

EFY: What are the biggest challenges in taking a chip from design to production in India?

SS: One of the biggest challenges is developing a clear product strategy. Companies need to decide which markets they want to serve, define their product lines, and create a roadmap for scaling their business. Although investment opportunities have improved thanks to research and deep-tech funding initiatives, attracting capital still depends on a strong go-to-market plan. Chip development also demands significant upfront investment, specialised expertise, and strong ecosystem partnerships, which sets it apart from software development.